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(b) Since the restoring spring force is F = - kx, when the object crosses the equilibrium position, it experiences no force. Note that at equilibrium position, the object moves very fast. When the object is at x = +10 m (elongation), the force F = – k x

F = – (1) (10) = – 10 N. Here the negative sign implies that the force is towards equilibrium i.e., towards negative x-axis and when the object is at $x = -10m$ (compression), it experiences a forces F = – (1) (– 10) = +10 N. Here the positive sign implies that the force points towards positive x-axis.

The object comes to momentary rest at $x = \pm 10m$ even though it experiences a maximum force at both these points.

4.2.9 Motion in a vertical circle

Imagine that a body of mass (m) attached to one end of a massless and inextensible string executes circular motion in a vertical plane with the other end of the string fixed. The length of the string becomes the radius ($\vec{r}$) of the circular path (Figure 4.14).

Let us discuss the motion of the body by taking the free body diagram (FBD) at a position where the position vector ($\vec{r}$) makes an angle θ with the vertically downward direction and the instantaneous velocity is as shown in Figure 4.14.

There are two forces acting on the mass.

1. Gravitational force which acts downward
2. Tension along the string.

Applying Newton's second law on the mass,

In the tangential direction,

$$mg\sin\theta = m a_t$$

$$mg\sin\theta = -m\left(\frac{dv}{dt}\right) \quad (4.28)$$

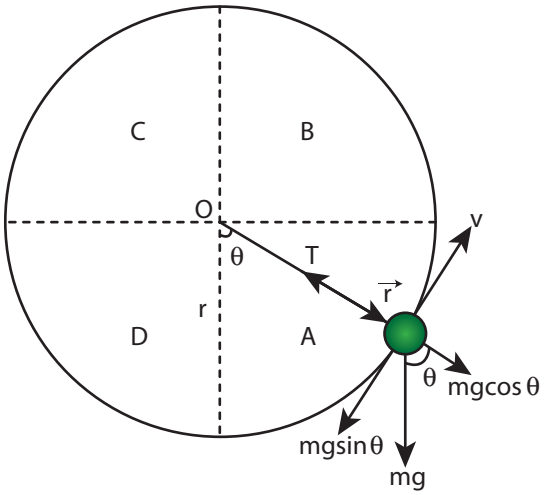


Figure 4.14 Motion in vertical circle

where, $a_t = -\frac{dv}{dt}$ is tangential retardation

In the radial direction,

$$T - mg\cos\theta = m a_r$$

$$T - mg\cos\theta = \frac{mv^2}{r} \quad (4.29)$$

where, $a_r = \frac{v^2}{r}$ is the centripetal acceleration.

The circle can be divided into four sections A, B, C, D for better understanding of the motion. The four important facts to be understood from the two equations are as follows:

(i) The mass is having tangential acceleration (g sin θ) for all values of θ (except θ = 0°), it is clear that this vertical cirular motion is not a uniform circular motion.

(ii) From the equations (4.28) and (4.29) it is understood that as the magnitude of velocity is not a constant in the course of motion, the tension in the string is also not constant.